

HORIZON NATIONAL BANK

Customer Complaint Policy 2026

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1. Purpose and Scope

This policy defines the grievance redressal framework available to customers of Horizon National Bank and the internal standards for handling complaints.

2. Complaint Channels

- Branch complaint register and complaint form.
- Customer care telephone line, available 24 hours.
- Internet and mobile banking complaint module.
- Email to the customer care mailbox.

Every complaint must be assigned a unique complaint reference number and acknowledged within 1 working day.

The complaint reference number must be communicated to the customer through the same channel on which the complaint was received.

3. Complaint Escalation Process

Complaints must be escalated through the following levels:

- Level 1: Branch Manager or Customer Care. Resolution within 7 working days.
- Level 2: Regional Nodal Officer, if the customer is not satisfied with the Level 1 response or if no response is received within 7 working days. Resolution within 10 working days.
- Level 3: Principal Nodal Officer at Head Office. Resolution within 15 working days.
- Level 4: The Banking Ombudsman, where the complaint remains unresolved for 30 days from the date of first receipt by the bank, or where the customer is not satisfied with the reply received.

Contact details for every level must be displayed in all branches and on the bank's website.

4. Complaint Severity Classification

- High severity: complaints involving financial loss, unauthorised transactions, suspected fraud, or repeated failure to respond. Must be actioned within 1 working day.
- Medium severity: complaints involving service delays, documentation issues or incorrect charges. Must be actioned within 3 working days.
- Low severity: information requests and general feedback. Must be actioned within 5 working days.

Severity is determined by the nature of the incident, not by the tone in which the complaint is expressed.

5. Repeat Complaints

A complaint reopened by the same customer on the same subject within 30 days must be automatically escalated one level above the level that issued the previous response.

6. Compensation

Where the bank is at fault and the customer has suffered a direct financial loss, the amount must be reversed along with applicable interest within 10 working days of the conclusion of the investigation.

7. Reporting

A consolidated complaint report including volumes, categories, ageing and root causes must be placed before the Customer Service Committee of the Board every quarter.

8. Root Cause Analysis

Any complaint category exceeding 50 instances in a quarter must undergo documented root cause analysis with a remediation plan and a named owner.

End of Customer Complaint Policy 2026. This document supersedes all prior versions. Queries to Customer Experience Department.